

6 Mobile phones

In this wireless and busy world, mobile phones can't be left far behind in the war of viruses and counter measures. Gone are the days when mobile were used only for placing calls and messaging. Today's mobile phones are used to do everything from calling, messaging, blogging, browsing, transferring files by means of Bluetooth and MMS. With cellular mobility and handhelds evolving by the months, and their increasing resemblance to computing devices, they are getting increasingly vulnerable to attacks and infringement of our privacy.

Every time you connect your phone to the computer to transfer images or share your contact list, you are just opening up yourself to a host of malicious coding out there aimed solely at causing harm to your device. Also, the next time you are in a public place and are sharing files over Bluetooth make sure you pair up with trustworthy devices. This could save you a lot of pain in the literal sense. Read on more to find out remedies in case you happen to be infected. Even if you aren't, you'll get to know of some helpful remedial steps to prevent such events.

6.1 Password protect phone access

Password protection is not a new feature in cellular phones. This is among those rarely used functions available in most handsets. All phones have this one function to set a password to your phone to prevent misuse. However, we do warn that you still need to monitor your phone and not leave it to unauthorised use. While going through the functions in your phone, you'll come across two security codes – PIN and PIN2. These are two codes which are generally 4 digits wide, but can go up to 8 digits. PIN is used to prevent unauthorised access to your cell phone. Normally, most OEMs set these to default values of 1234 and 12345, respectively. You or the handset user would be prompted to key in the PIN on accessing keypad.

Similarly, in order to access the priority numbers in the phone, there is another PIN2 that you need to key in. As a protective measure, the phone gives you just three chances at entering the correct PIN. So be sure, don't take your password lightly. If you don't get the code right on the third try, the subscriber identity module (SIM) card gets locked. Once your SIM card is locked, you